

Using SharePoint

For those few users who have access to a SharePoint document repository, the Windows Phone picture is considerably brighter, and certainly more seamless, than it is with Windows Live SkyDrive. That's because Microsoft has built an incredible SharePoint client right into the Office hub. SharePoint, for those who aren't aware, is one of the most successful platforms Microsoft has ever created. It's a server product that installs on top of modern Windows Server versions, providing collaboration and web-based publishing functionality to business users. In fact, SharePoint is a jack-of-all-trades type solution, which is part of the reason for its huge success: Businesses use SharePoint to create web sites, web portals, intranets and extranets, content management systems, wikis, blogs, and other types of web-based content sites.

Another, equally important aspect of SharePoint's success in the corporate world is that it's self-servicing. This means that information workers who wish to set up a site for document collaboration or other purposes can do so immediately, via a simple web-based interface, and without having to grovel to busy administrators and IT professionals who are probably already busy with other tasks. Using a simple delegation model, admins can configure SharePoint once and then leave the company's workers free to go about their business.

We are not going to provide a thorough SharePoint overview here as it is out of the scope of most regular users. You either have access to SharePoint or you don't. If you do, you're in luck, because Windows Phone has incredible SharePoint integration functionality. If you don't, you can look to this integration as a clue to what future SkyDrive integration could look like. Indeed, from the perspective of users, SkyDrive and SharePoint work similarly in terms of document storage and access. Why Windows Phone ships with vastly superior Share-Point integration is unclear.

The SharePoint client on Windows Phone is called SharePoint Workspace Mobile, and it is exposed as a prominent part of the Office hub. In fact, it occupies fully 50 per cent of the Office hub panorama, or the two rightmost sections, or columns. If you haven't yet connected to a SharePoint site, you can do so now by tapping the Open URL button. Then, type in the address of your SharePoint Server. You'll be prompted for a username, password, and domain as well.

When you make the connection, SharePoint Workspace will list the various server-based libraries and lists that are available to you. To inves-